Medicine Recommendation System

This is general information only, not medical advice. Please consult a doctor.

Enter symptoms

fever headache bodypain

Get recommendation

Recommendation

General information – fever, headache & body aches

Symptom	Common over-the-counter (OTC) options	Simple home-care tips
Fever (temperature ≥ 38 °C / 100.4 °F)	• **Acetaminophen** (paracetamol) – 500 mg – 1 g every 4-6 h (max 4 g/24 h). • **Ibuprofen** – 200-400 mg every 6-8 h (max 1.2 g/24 h). • **Aspirin** – *only* for adults who are not pregnant and have no bleeding risk (300-1000 mg every 4-6 h, max 4 g/24 h).	• Drink plenty of fluids (water, clear broth, oral rehydration solutions). • Light clothing; keep the room comfortably cool (≈20-22 °C). • Use a cool, damp washcloth on forehead or take a lukewarm sponge bath.
Headache (often accompanies fever)	• Same agents as for fever (acetaminophen or ibuprofen). • **Caffeine-containing analgesics** (e.g., acetaminophen + caffeine) can be helpful if you tolerate caffeine.	• Rest in a dark, quiet room. • Apply a warm or cold pack to the forehead/temples (whichever feels better). • Limit screen time and loud noises.
Body / muscle pain (myalgia)	• **Ibuprofen** or **naproxen** (NSAIDs) are often more effective for inflammatory-type aches. •	• Gentle stretching or short walks as tolerated. • Warm showers or heating

Symptom	Common over-the-counter (OTC) options	Simple home-care tips
	Acetaminophen works for mild-to-moderate pain if NSAIDs are contraindicated.	pads (15 min at a time). • Massage with a light, non-oil-based lotion.

How to choose the right OTC medicine

Situation	Preferred option
No stomach-ulcer, kidney, or heart-failure concerns	**Ibuprofen** (or naproxen) – good for pain + inflammation.
History of ulcer, kidney disease, or you're taking blood thinners	**Acetaminophen** – gentler on the stomach and platelets.
Pregnant (especially ≤ 20 weeks)	**Acetaminophen** only; avoid NSAIDs and aspirin unless specifically advised.
Children < 12 y	Use **acetaminophen** or **ibuprofen** formulations made for children; dose by weight (check the label or ask a pharmacist). **Never give aspirin to children** with fever because of the risk of Reye's syndrome.

Safety reminders

- **Read the label** – follow the maximum daily dose and interval warnings.
- Do **not** combine two products that contain the same active ingredient (e.g., "cold-and-flu" combos + extra acetaminophen).
- Take NSAIDs with food or milk to reduce stomach irritation.
- If you have chronic conditions (asthma, liver disease, kidney disease, heart disease, hypertension, diabetes, bleeding disorders) or are on prescription meds (anticoagulants, steroids, diuretics, etc.), check with a pharmacist or your clinician before starting an NSAID.
- For children, always use the **exact measuring device** that comes with the product (syringe, dropper, dosing cup).

When to see a doctor (or go to urgent care / emergency department)

Red-flag symptom	Why it matters	Action
Fever ≥ 39.4 °C (103 °F) lasting > 24 h or **re-rising after it has come down**	May indicate a more serious infection.	Call your primary-care provider (PCP) or urgent-care clinic.
Severe or worsening headache (e.g., "worst headache of my life")	Could signal meningitis, intracranial bleed, or other serious cause.	Seek emergency care immediately.
Stiff neck, photophobia, confusion, seizures	Classic signs of meningitis or encephalitis.	Emergency department.
Persistent vomiting (≥ 2-3 times in 6 h) or inability to keep fluids down	Risk of dehydration and electrolyte imbalance.	Contact a clinician; may need IV fluids.
Rash that spreads quickly, especially with fever (e.g., petechiae, purpura)	Possible meningococcal infection or other serious illness.	Emergency care.
Shortness of breath, chest pain, rapid heartbeat	Could be a cardiac or pulmonary complication.	Emergency department.
Pain that does not improve after 2-3 days of appropriate OTC therapy	May need prescription medication or further evaluation.	Schedule a visit with your PCP.
Underlying health conditions (e.g., immunosuppression, chronic lung disease, diabetes) that develop fever/headache/body aches	Higher risk of complications.	Contact your clinician early.
Infants < 3 months with fever (≥ 38 °C / 100.4 °F)	Very low threshold for serious infection.	Immediate medical evaluation.

Quick "at-home" checklist

1. **Take temperature** – record the highest reading and the time you took it.
2. **Start an appropriate OTC** (acetaminophen 500 mg or ibuprofen 200 mg for most adults) **if no contraindications**.
3. **Hydrate** – aim for ≥ 2 L of fluid per day (more if sweating a lot).
4. **Rest** – limit physical activity; sleep helps the immune system.

5. **Monitor** – check temperature every 4-6 h, note any new symptoms (rash, breathing difficulty, worsening pain).
6. **Re-evaluate** – if after 48 h you're still febrile, pain is severe, or any red-flag appears, reach out to a health professional.

Bottom line: For most healthy adults, acetaminophen or ibuprofen combined with rest, fluids, and temperature-control measures will relieve fever, headache, and body aches. Keep an eye on the "red-flag" signs listed above; if any appear, or if you have chronic medical problems that could be worsened by fever or NSAIDs, seek medical care promptly.

This information is for educational purposes only and does not replace personalized medical advice. Always follow the instructions on medication labels and consult a qualified health professional if you are unsure.